MIL-F-36053B
27 September 1976
SUPERSEDING
MIL-F-36053A
6 September 1974 and
MIL-F-36053
24 May 1961

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

FORCEPS, SUTURE CLIP, APPLYING AND REMOVING, MICHEL, 11-18 MM

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers a suture forceps, of the Michel design, suitable for applying and removing suture clips.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposals, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein:

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

GG-I-526	- Instruments, Dental and Surgical; General Specifications.
PPP-B-566	- Boxes, Folding, Paperboard.
PPP-B-585	- Boxes, Wood, Wirebound.
PPP-B-601	- Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood.
PPP-B-621	- Boxes, Wood, Nailed and Lock-Corner.
PPP-B-636	- Box, Fiberboard.
PPP-B-676	- Boxes, Set-Up.

MILITARY

MIL-L-116	- Preservation, Methods of.
MIL-L-10547	- Liners, Case, and Sheet Overwrap; Water-Vaporproof or Waterproof, Flexible.

Beneficial documents (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: Hq., Defense Personnel Support Center, ATTN: Directorate of Medical Materiel, Code ATT, 2800 South 20th Street, Philadelphia, PA 19101, by using the self addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-21T08:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-105	Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129	Marking for Shipment and Storage.

DRAWING

Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC)

No. 20212	FORCEPS, SUTURE CLIP, APPLYING AND REMOVING, MICHEL, 11-18 mm.

(Copies of specifications, standards and drawing required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. Forceps shall be fabricated from class 4, type 410 or 420 material in accordance with GG-I-526. As an alternate, the spring shall be fabricated from spring temper austenitic corrosion-resisting steel. All material shall be properly passivated as a final finishing operation. Rockwell hardness of class 4 material shall be C40 to C45 after proper stress relieving. Hardness testing shall be performed as specified in GG-I-526. Corrosion tests shall be as specified in GG-I-526; the boil test shall apply for austenitic corrosion-resisting steel as specified in GG-I-526.

3.2 Style, design and dimensions. Shall be a forceps, of the Michel design, suitable for applying and removing Michel suture clips (sizes 11 to 18 millimeters). Forceps shall be of box lock construction, possessing single or double spring design for suitable jaw alignment. Forceps shall possess a male working member that shall fit easily and freely into the cavity of the female jaw working member at the distal end of the forceps. These jaws shall be the removal end of the forceps for suture grasping and removal. The proximal end of both handles shall be formed as shown on the drawing and shall constitute the suture applying end of the forceps. Further, the proximal end of both handles shall possess intermeshing teeth that shall be properly aligned to form tweezer-like formation for grasping particles from the suturing site. The spring (or springs) shall be easily removed. Handles of the forceps shall be serrated. Style, design and dimensions of the forceps shall be in accordance with DPSC Drawing No. 20212.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T08:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3 Finish. Finish shall be mirror, or mirror and satin, as defined in GG-I-526.

3.4 Performance test. When tested as specified in 4.4.1, the male jaw shall enter the cavity of the female jaw without butting, hitting, or scraping the surfaces of the female cavity. A suture clip, of the Michel design, ranging from size 11 to 18 millimeters in length shall be capable of being compressed (with the two sharp points of the suture clip touching), and also shall be capable of straightening (spring-back) the Michel suture clip without breaking or cracking the suture clip. For reference purposes only, the suture clip to be used in the test shall be NSN 6515-00-375-4110 CLIP, SUTURE, MICHEL, 16 mm. In addition, closure and opening of the forceps shall be easy, free from drag or binding during the test. In the normally open position, the male jaw shall not enter the cavity of the female jaw, and the teeth at the applying end of each handle shall not engage.

3.5 Identification marking. Forceps shall be permanently and legibly marked with the name or registered trademark of the contractor and the word "stainless". Further, instruments of foreign manufacture (i.e., other than U.S.) shall, in addition to the above, be marked with the country of origin.

3.6 Workmanship. Workmanship shall be first class throughout. All serrations and intermeshing teeth shall be well defined. Finish shall be smooth, uniform, free from burrs, cracks, pits, holes, scale and corrosion.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government, upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of 3 years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T08:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.1.2 Inspection. Inspection, as used in this specification, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing determination by technical means by physical and chemical properties) of the item.

4.1.3 Certificates of quality. Certificates of quality, supplied by the manufacturer of the corrosion-resistant metals may be furnished in lieu of actual performance of such testing by the contractor, provided lot identity has been maintained and can be demonstrated to the Government. The certificate shall include the name of the contractor, the contract number, the name of the manufacturer or supplier, the National Stock Number, the item identification, the name of the component/material, the lot number, the lot size, the sample size, the date of testing, the test method, individual test results, and the specification requirements.

4.2 Sampling.

4.2.1 For examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in table I. The unit of product for examination purposes shall be one forceps.

TABLE I. Sampling criteria for examination.

Type defect	Inspection level	AQL (percent defective)
Major	II	1.0
Minor	II	2.5

4.2.2 For tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, and as indicated in table II. Where feasible, the same sample unit shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one forceps.

TABLE II. Sampling criteria for tests.

Component	Characteristic	Requirement	Test procedure	Insp. level	AQL (percent defective)
Forceps	Hardness	3.1	GG-I-526	S-2	1,5
	Copper sulfate test (For class 4 material)	3.1	GG-I-526	S-2	1.5
	Boil test (For all material)	3.1	GG-I-526	S-2	1.5
	Dimensions	3.2	---	S-2	4.0
	Performance test	3.4	4.4.1	S-2	1.5

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T08:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

4.2.3 Raw materials. A sufficient quantity of each lot of each metal used in the construction of the forceps shall be selected for chemical analysis.

4.3 Examination. The forceps shall be examined to determine compliance with all the requirements contained in this specification. Examination shall be conducted as specified in tables I and III. Examination, however, shall not be restricted to defects listed in table III. Any forceps in the sample containing one or more defects shall be rejected and if the number of defective forceps in any sample exceeds the acceptance number for that sample, the lot represented by that sample shall be rejected.

TABLE III. Classification of defects.

Categories	Defects
Critical	None defined.
Major	
101	Forceps not of the design specified.
102	Handles possess serrations that are not well defined.
103	Intermeshing teeth at applying end not well defined.
104	Spring mechanism not capable of easy removal.
105	Box-lock exhibits excessive or free play.
106	Finish not as specified.
107	Forceps nor free from burrs, cracks, pits, holes, scale or corrosion.
Minor	
201	Identification marking not as specified.

4.3.1 Packaging inspection. The inspection of the preservation-packaging shall be in accordance with the group A and B quality conformance inspection requirements of MIL-P-116. The inspection of the packing and marking for shipment and storage shall be in accordance with the quality assurance provisions of the applicable container specification and the marking requirements of MIL-STD-129.

4.4 Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements.

4.4.1 Performance test. The forceps shall be observed first in the normally open position (no force exerted on the handles). Should the male jaw enter the cavity of the female jaw, the forceps shall be rejected. The forceps shall be depressed with the thumb and middle finger (or thumb and index finger) with light pressure and without the exertion of lateral force. The male jaw shall be observed for entry into the cavity of the female jaw, and the teeth at the applying end shall be simultaneously observed for proper intermeshing (alignment).

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T08:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

Lateral play, drag, or bind action of the spring shall be cause for rejection during this test. The forceps shall then be tested for suture clip compressibility and straightening by using the suture clip specified in 3.4, or equivalent. The clip shall be placed lengthwise between the handle cutout of the forceps, with the sharp points of the clip facing away from the spring. The forceps shall be closed, utilizing one hand only, with a straight, positive motion. Should the forceps properly compress the clip, so that the two sharp points of the clip touch, without the clip breaking or cracking, then the spring-back test shall be performed. The curved or compressed surface of the clip (sharp points facing down) shall be placed between the removal jaws of the forceps (with the cavity of the female jaw facing the operator). The forceps shall then be closed in the same manner described above, the clip shall be observed for clip spring-back.

5. PACKAGING

5.1 Preservation-packaging. Preservation-packaging shall be level A or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Unit of issue. One forceps, as specified, constitutes one unit of issue.

5.1.2 Packaging quanitities. The number of units of issue indicated in table IV shall be packaged in each unit, intermediate, and exterior container, as applicable, for the required level of protection specified in the procurement document.

TABLE IV. Packaging quantities

Unit package	Intermediate package	Exterior container
1 unit	12 units	288 units

5.1.2.1 Packing variation permitted. If the required number of units in the entire shipment is less than the number of units specified to be overpacked in an exterior container, such units may be packed in an exterior container of suitable size and design, acceptable to a common carrier, which shall insure safe delivery to destination.

5.1.3 Level A.

5.1.3.1 Cleaning and drying. Each unit shall be throughly cleaned and dried in accordance with the applicable methods as outlined in MIL-P-116.

5.1.3.2 Preservative. Preservative shall not be applied.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T08:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.1.3.3 Intimate wrap. Each unit shall be wrapped in neutral tissue or other suitable anticorrosive material.

5.1.3.4 Unit package. Each unit shall be packaged in accordance with MIL-P-116, method IC-1.

5.1.3.5 Intermediate package. Intermediate package shall be a box of appropriate size constructed in accordance with PPP-B-566, PPP-B-676 or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specifications.

5.1.4 Level C. Units shall be packaged in standard commercial containers of the size and kind commonly used, which will afford the degree of protection required for shipment and use of the product for its intended purpose.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be Level A, B or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.2.1 Level A.

5.2.1.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 3, style 3; PPP-B-601, overseas type; PPP-B-621, class 2; or PPP-B-636, class weather-resistant, grade V3c. Closure and strapping shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.1.2 Case liner. Each Level A wood box shall be lined with a waterproof case liner conforming to MIL-L-10547. Closure and strapping shall conform to applicable paragraphs of appendix thereto. Case liner shall not be required for fiberboard boxes Fiberboard box shall be waterproof in accordance with the appendix of PPP-B-636.

5.2.2 Level B.

5.2.2.1 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be designed for a type 2 load and constructed in accordance with PPP-B-585, class 1, style 3; PPP-B-601, domestic type; PPP-B-621, class 1; or PPP-B-636, class domestic. Closure shall be as specified in the appendix of the applicable box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The subject commodity shall be packed in substantial commercial containers of the type, size, and kind commonly used for the purpose, so constructed as to insure acceptance and safe delivery by common or other carriers, at the lowest rate, to point of delivery called for in the contract or purchase order.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Interior packages. Each unit package and each intermediate package shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T08:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

5.3.2 Exterior container. Exterior container shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Applicable levels of packaging and packing (see 5.1 and 5.2).
(c) National Stock Number.

6.2 National Stock Number coverage. This specification covers the following item appearing in the Federal Supply Catalog:

National Stock Number	Item Identification
6515-00-332-5900	FORCEPS, SUTURE CLIP, Applying and Removing, Michel, 11-18 mm.

6.3 Changes. The margins of this specification are marked with an asterisk to indicate where changes (additions, modifications, corrections, deletions) from the previous issue were made. This was done as a convenience only and the Government assumes no liability whatsoever for any inaccuracies in these notations. Bidders and contractors are cautioned to evaluate the requirements of this document based on the entire content irrespective of the marginal notations and relationship to the last previous issue.

Custodians:
Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing activity:
Defense Supply Agency - DM

Project No. 6515-2010

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T08:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

OMB Approval
No. 22-R255

INSTRUCTIONS: The purpose of this form is to solicit beneficial comments which will help achieve procurement of suitable products at reasonable cost and minimum delay, or will otherwise enhance use of the document. DoD contractors, government activities, or manufacturers/vendors who are prospective suppliers of the product are invited to submit comments to the government. Fold on lines on reverse side, staple in corner, and send to preparing activity. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document(s) or to amend contractual requirements. Attach any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document. If there are additional papers, attach to form and place both in an envelope addressed to preparing activity.

DOCUMENT IDENTIFIER AND TITLE
MIL-F-36053B - FORCEPS, SUTURE CLIP, APPLYING AND REMOVING, MICHEL, 11-18 MM

NAME OF ORGANIZATION AND ADDRESS	CONTRACT NUMBER
	MATERIAL PROCURED UNDER A ☐ DIRECT GOVERNMENT CONTRACT ☐ SUBCONTRACT

1. HAS ANY PART OF THE DOCUMENT CREATED PROBLEMS OR REQUIRED INTERPRETATION IN PROCUREMENT USE?
   A. GIVE PARAGRAPH NUMBER AND WORDING.

   B. RECOMMENDATIONS FOR CORRECTING THE DEFICIENCIES

2. COMMENTS ON ANY DOCUMENT REQUIREMENT CONSIDERED TOO RIGID

3. IS THE DOCUMENT RESTRICTIVE?
   ☐ YES ☐ NO *(If "Yes", in what way?)*

4. REMARKS

SUBMITTED BY *(Printed or typed name and address - Optional)*	TELEPHONE NO.
	DATE

DD FORM 1 JAN 72 1426 REPLACES EDITION OF 1 JAN 66 WHICH MAY BE USED

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-21T08:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

FOLD

DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER
2800 South 20th Street
Philadelphia, PA 19101

POSTAGE AND FEES PAID
DEFENSE SUPPLY AGENCY
DoD - 304

U.S. MAIL

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

HEADQUARTERS, DEFENSE PERSONNEL SUPPORT CENTER
ATTN: DIRECTORATE OF MEDICAL MATERIEL, CODE ATT
2800 SOUTH 20TH STREET
PHILADELPHIA, PA 19101

FOLD

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-21T08:01Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.